



**AMT COBOL
FILECONVERTER
TRAINING MANUAL**

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1 INTRODUCTION

The AMT COBOL FileConverter is an application designed to convert data files which have been created on a mainframe, in EBCDIC format, into ASCII files, whilst retaining the integrity of the data held within the file.

No specific installation steps need to be taken. The latest version of the AMT COBOL FileConverter can be deployed wherever you wish – even to a non-AMT directory.

The screenshot shows the 'Flat File Converter - v1.3.0' application window. It features a 'Convert' button and fields for 'Input file:' and 'Output file:'. Below these are buttons for 'Get Rec Size', 'Show Pos', 'Load Settings', 'Save Settings', and 'Clear Settings'. The 'Record size' is set to 100. The 'Mainframe' is set to 'Unisys A-series'. The 'Record Ending' is set to 'Default'. The 'Overpunch' is set to 'AMT'. There are checkboxes for 'Output Signed Overpunch' (checked), 'Output Trailing Sign', 'Convert COMP Values', and 'Don't validate COMP Values'. There is also a checkbox for 'Ibm Rdw'. A section for 'Invalid computational values' has two radio buttons: 'Convert value to 000000' and 'Convert value to 999999' (selected). There is a 'Custom Encoding' field. Below these are checkboxes for 'Header record', 'Detail records' (checked), and 'Footer record'. A 'Conditional detail records' field is set to 0, with an 'Apply' button. A 'Records:' label is on the right. At the bottom, there are tabs for 'Detail', 'Logging', 'Comments', and 'EBCDIC - ASCII Conversion Table'. The 'Detail' tab is active, showing a 'Filter' dropdown set to 'None' and a 'Record Description (01 level)' field.

The application itself is not a licensed product but should only be used during the migration project.

1.1 Why do these files require special conversion?

It is common for mainframe files to contain numeric data in a compressed format (referred to as Computational Data or COMP). If this COMP field is also signed, the sign is held, whether it be a positive or a negative sign, as an over-punch on the least significant digit. It is this over-punched sign that is not converted correctly in a standard file conversion (i.e. using FTP) where a non-binary transfer will automatically convert the file to ASCII format.

The Input file **must be** transferred from the mainframe in EBCDIC characters using the **binary** option for the ftp, so that all of the hexadecimal characters remain the same.

The AMT COBOL FileConverter is able to correctly convert the files using the record layout defined for the creation of the file on the mainframe.

However, the complexity increases when the same data area is used by multiple record layouts, all of which contain signed COMP fields in different positions. In this instance, multiple layouts must be declared – one for each different record definition.

1.2 Recommended directory structure

To organize the input, output and settings files that the file converter uses it is suggested that a simple file directory structure is implemented.

```
Là Cobol File Conversion
  Là Exe
    Là ConvertCobolFiles.Exe
  Là Input
    Là Data_01
    Là Data_02
  Là Logs
    Là Data_01.Log
    Là Data_02.Log
  Là Output
    Là Data_01
    Là Data_02
  Là Converter Settings
    Là Data_01_Settings.ini
    Là Data_02_Settings.ini
```

If several different sets of files are to be used for input (perhaps from different testing phases or different overnight batches) it may be advisable to hold these files in separately named staging directories and then copy them into the Input directory when the conversion is to take place.

2 Using the AMT COBOL FileConverter to Convert a Single File

Launch the application and the following screen is displayed:

Flat File Converter - v1.0.0

Single File Converter | Multiple File converter | EBCDIC - ASCII Conversion Table

Convert

Input file: [] []

Output file: [] []

Get Rec Size

Show Pos

Record size: [0] []

Mainframe: [IBM z/OS] [v]

Record Ending: [Default] [v]

Overpunch: [AMT] [v]

Custom Encoding: []

☐ Header record ☒ Detail records ☐ Footer record

Conditional detail records: [0] [] [Apply]

Records: []

☐ Output Signed Overpunch ☐ Ibm Rdw

☐ Output Trailing Sign ☐ Convert to SQLite

☐ Convert COMP Values ☐ Don't validate COMP Values

Invalid computational values

☐ Convert value to 000000

☒ Convert value to 999999

Detail | Logging | Comments

Filter

[None] [v]

Record Description (01 level)

A number of parameters must be specified before the conversion can take place.

The following table explains what information is required.

Parameter	Description
Input file	The location of the files to be converted. Enter the full path or use the button to navigate to the correct location
Output file	The location of the converted files. Enter the full path or use the button to navigate to the correct location

Record size	The maximum length of each record. NB each file must be of fixed length (i.e. spaces must not be trimmed on FTP from the mainframe).
Mainframe	Specify either Unisys or IBM
Record Ending	Choose: Default CRLF CR LF None
Overpunch	Choose: AMT COBOL ANSI Mainframe (EBCDIC) Unix Custom
Output signed overpunch	Check the box if the converted file should contain the overpunch character for signed fields
Output trailing sign	Check the box if the converted file should contain a trailing sign for signed fields
Convert COMP values	Check the box if COMP fields are to be converted in the converted file
Don't validate COMP values	Check the box if COMP fields are to not be validated during the conversion process
IBM Rdw	Indicates that the input file contains variable length records has been copied using the RDW option
Invalid computational values	Choose the required option of these are to be converted
Convert value to 000000	Invalid values will be converted to zeros

Convert value to 999999	Invalid values will be converted to all 9's
Custom encoding	Enter required encoding set e.g. Swedish = RQPONMLKJåäABCDEFghi
Header record	Check the box if the input file contains a header record
Detail records	Check the box if the input file contains detail records
Footer record	Check the box if the input file contains a footer record
Conditional detail records	Check the box if the input file contains multiple detail records. Enter the number of additional record layouts contained in the file. Click the Apply button to create additional Detail sections in the lower panel

2.1 Record Layouts

Having set the options for record layouts in the upper panel, the lower panel is used to define each layout.

The definition of each layout for the file should be copied directly from the Cobol source code and pasted into the appropriate frame description area. The button "get rec size" is then pressed to establish the record length.

The following sections explain how to configure the settings for a file with a header, footer and detail records.

2.1.1 Header Record Layout

To specify a header record, check the “Header record” check box. This automatically creates a “Header” tab sheet in the lower panel.

This tab sheet is used to specify the header layout in the “Record frame description” area.

This layout will only be applied to the very first record in the file.

The definition of a header layout can be seen in the screen print below.

The screenshot displays the Flat File Converter v1.3.0 application window. The 'Convert' button is visible at the top left. The 'Input file' field shows 'D:\SPV\Convert_COBOL_Files\InFiles\Y210.DEL8.BN38502.TF.CN38.RDW.dat'. The 'Output file' field shows 'D:\SPV\Convert_COBOL_Files\OutFiles\CN38.dat'. The 'Record size' is set to 110. The 'Mainframe' is set to 'IBM z/OS'. The 'Record Ending' is set to 'None'. The 'Overpunch' is set to 'CUSTOM'. The 'Custom Encoding' is set to 'RQPONMLKJHABCEFGHI'. The 'Header record' checkbox is checked. The 'Detail records' checkbox is checked. The 'Footer record' checkbox is unchecked. The 'Conditional detail records' field is set to 19. The 'Records' field is empty. The 'Filter' dropdown is set to 'None'. The 'Record Description (01 level)' section shows the following details:

Record	Description	Field	Value
01	UTBET.		
05	U-PNR	PIC 9(10).	
*			* RETRONR INOM PERIOD
05	U-RE-KOER-LOPNR	PIC X.	
*			* RETRO-LOPNR, PERSON
05	U-RE-PNR-LOPNR	PIC 9.	
*			* POSTTYP
05	U-PTYP	PIC 9(2).	
*			* POSTTYPLOPNR
*			* EV FOR PTYP 22
05	U-PLNR	PIC 9(2).	
*			* VERKSAMHETSOMRÅDE
05	U-VOKOD	PIC 9(3).	
*			* FÖRÅNSLOPNR
05	U-FORML	PIC 9(3).	
*			* BELOPPSKOD
05	U-BELKOD	PIC 9(3).	
*			
05	U-DATA.		
*			* RESTEN AV LÅNGSTA
*			* POSTTYPENS DATA
10	U-DATAREST	PIC X(85).	

2.1.2 Footer Record Layout

The footer details are specified in a similar way to the header record described earlier, but this time checking the “Footer record” check box and using the Footer tab sheet that is automatically created.

This record layout will only be applied to the very last record in the file.

The definition of a footer layout can be seen in the screen print below.

The screenshot shows the 'Flat File Converter - v1.3.0 [MODIFIED]' application window. The 'Convert' button is visible at the top left. The 'Input file' and 'Output file' fields are populated with paths. The 'Record size' is set to 110. The 'Mainframe' is set to 'IBM z/OS'. The 'Record ending' is set to 'None'. The 'Overpunch' is set to 'CUSTOM'. The 'Custom Encoding' is set to 'RQPONMLK&ABCEFGH'. The 'Footer record' checkbox is checked. The 'Conditional detail records' is set to 19. The 'Records' field is empty. The 'Filter' dropdown is set to 'None'. The 'Record Description (01 level)' is displayed as follows:

Record	Description	Field	Format
01	FOOTER-REC.		
02	F-KEY-AREA.		
03	F-CALC-DATE	PIC 9(6).	
03	F-CALC-TIME	PIC 9(8).	
02	FILLER	PIC X(96).	

2.1.3 Detail Record Layout

A common feature of the Cobol programs using disk files for input is the re-mapping of the data area to enable multiple record layouts against the same file Id.

To support the presence of different record layouts within the Detail record of the file, multiple Detail tabs can be created.

This multi-layout approach enables decimal numeric fields, declared as COMP, to be correctly translated, including the over-punched signs.

2.1.3.1 The Default Layout

The first Detail layout that is created is treated as the default layout, and the reformatting related to this layout will take place if the record read does not conform to any of the filtering employed on the subsequent Detail tabs (D01...Dnn).

For this reason, no Filtering or Content options are available when defining the Record Frame Description for the Default Detail layout.

Flat File Converter - v1.3.0 [MODIFIED]

Convert: Input file: D:\SPV\Convert_COBOL_Files\InFiles\Y210.DEL&BN38502.TF.CH38.RDW.dat
Output file: D:\SPV\Convert_COBOL_Files\OutFiles\CH38.dat

Get Rec Size: Record size: 110
Mainframe: IBM z/OS
Record Ending: None

Load Settings: Overpunch: CUSTOM
Custom Encoding: RQRNMLGJ&ABCDPQH

Save Settings: ☒ Header record ☒ Detail records ☐ Footer record
Conditional detail records: 19 Apply

Record Description (D1 level)

```
01 U10-POST REDEFINES UTBET.  
05 FILLER PIC X(12).  
05 U10-PTYP PIC S(2).  
05 FILLER PIC X(11).  
05 U10-UTBETMOD PIC X(3).  
05 U10-PERIOD PIC X(6).  
05 U10-SEKEL PIC S(2) COMP-3.  
05 U10-DOD PIC X(1).  
05 U10-UPPHITIDP PIC S(8) COMP-3.  
05 U10-UPPHKOD PIC X(1).  
05 U10-KTOKOD PIC X(1).  
05 U10-DELKOD PIC X(2).  
05 U10-ANTBT PIC S(1) COMP-3.  
05 U10-SALDOWOD PIC S(2) COMP-3.  
05 U10-SPECKOD PIC S(2) COMP-3.  
05 U10-LANKOM PIC S(4) COMP-3.  
05 U10-UTBET-35 PIC X(1).  
05 U10-ALEMY PIC X(6).  
05 U10-ALFMY PIC X(6).  
05 U10-TASKOL PIC X(5).  
05 U10-SKPLBEL PIC S(7) COMP-3.  
05 U10-KOD PIC X(1).  
05 U10-JAHON PIC S(5) COMP-3.  
05 U10-FPGRUPP PIC S(3) COMP-3.  
05 U10-FPART PIC S(2) COMP-3.  
05 U10-TPART PIC S(2) COMP-3.  
05 U10-DELSYST PIC S(3) COMP-3.  
05 U10-PONR PIC S(4) COMP-3.  
05 U10-SHYND PIC S(1) COMP-3.  
05 U10-SPECHARK PIC S(1) COMP-3.  
05 FILLER PIC X(17).
```

2.1.3.2 Filtered and Conditional Detail Layouts

To filter the input file using the data contained within the record (e.g. Position 13, Length 2, Type = Numeric, where the value is 11) as shown here in Layout D01.

Header Detail D01 D02 D03 D04 D05 D06 D07 D08 D09 D10 D11 D12 D13 D14 D15 D16 D17 D18 D19 Logging Comments EBCDIC - ASCII Conversion Table

Filter

Content

Position: 13 Type: Numeric LOW-VALUES HIGH-VALUES

Length: 2 Value: 11 Range till: 11

☐ AND

A filter can also be applied on a row count basis. Select the Row Number option in the Filter drop down list. Rows that are to use the current layout can be selected by their row number in the file, (i.e. 17-22, 28-32, 44) as shown here in Layout D02.

Header Detail D01 D02 D03 D04 D05 D06 D07 D08 D09 D10 D11 D12 D13 D14 D15 D16 D17 D18 D19 Logging Comments EBCDIC - ASCII Conversion Table

Filter

Row numbers

Row ids

2-22 Add

3-32 Del

4-44 Chg

From row: 4 To row: 44

This will define which Detail Layout should be applied to those rows.

A maximum of 99 different filtered or conditional detail layouts can be specified for a file.

2.1.4 Filtering Precedence

It is possible that, for a specific data row, more than one filtering rule could be applicable. If that is the case, then it is important that the precedence rules of the conversion filtering is understood so that the data row is updated correctly during the conversion.

In order to ensure that the correct layout mask is applied to the data row, it is necessary to remember that the Detail Layout masks will be assessed in the following order:

- 1) Record layouts defined as Header or Footer for the first and last record in the file.
- 2) Data Row and Data Content filters, applied in order D01 to D99
- 3) Default Data layout A new layout is only required when the over-punched sign of a signed computational numeric field occurs in a different character position to the layouts already defined.

2.1.5 Cross-referencing detail layouts

To simplify the task of comparing the various Detail layouts, the character start position of each data item in the Record Frame Description can be displayed.

To display the character positions for each data item within each of the Detail layouts press the "Show Pos" button in the button bar on the left-hand side.

The start character position of each active data item is placed in the right-hand margin, and at the end of the layout definition the full record size will be shown. This also enables the record size of each layout to be compared to ensure equality throughout each of the Detail layouts

The screenshot displays the AMT COBOL FileConverter interface. At the top, a tabbed menu includes 'Header', 'Detail', and a series of tabs labeled D01 through D19, followed by 'Logging', 'Comments', and 'EBCDIC - ASCII Conversion Table'. The 'Detail' tab is active. Below the tabs, a 'Filter' section on the left contains a 'Content' dropdown menu. To the right of the filter, there are input fields for 'Position' (set to 12) and 'Length' (set to 2). Further right, a 'Type' dropdown is set to 'Numeric', and there are radio buttons for 'LOW-VALUES' and 'HIGH-VALUES'. Below these, there is a 'Value' field set to '11' and a 'Range till' field set to '11'. An 'AND' checkbox is also present. The main area of the interface shows the 'Record Description (01 level)' with a table of data items and their positions:

Item	Description	Position
01	U11-POST	0
05	FILLER	0
05	U11-PTYP	12
05	FILLER	14
05	U11-RE-FROM	25
05	U11-RE-TOM	30
05	U11-RE-DATUM	35
05	FILLER	40
***** RECORD SIZE:		45

If the maximum record size of all the layouts defined for this file is required, then you can press the "Get RecSize" button in the button bar on the left-hand side. This will update the Record size value shown in the field next to the button.

Flat File Converter - v1.3.0

Convert Input file:

Output file:

Get Rec Size Record size:

Show Pos:

Mainframe:

Record Ending:

Overpunch:

Custom Encoding:

☒ Output Signed Overpunch
☐ Output Trailing Sign
☐ Convert COMP Values
☐ Don't validate COMP Values

☐ IBM Rdlw
 Invalid computational values
☐ Convert value to 000000
☒ Convert value to 999999

Load Settings
 Save Settings
 Clear Settings

☐ Header record
☒ Detail records
☐ Footer record

Conditional detail records: Apply

Records:

Detail | Logging | Comments | EBCDIC - ASCII Conversion Table

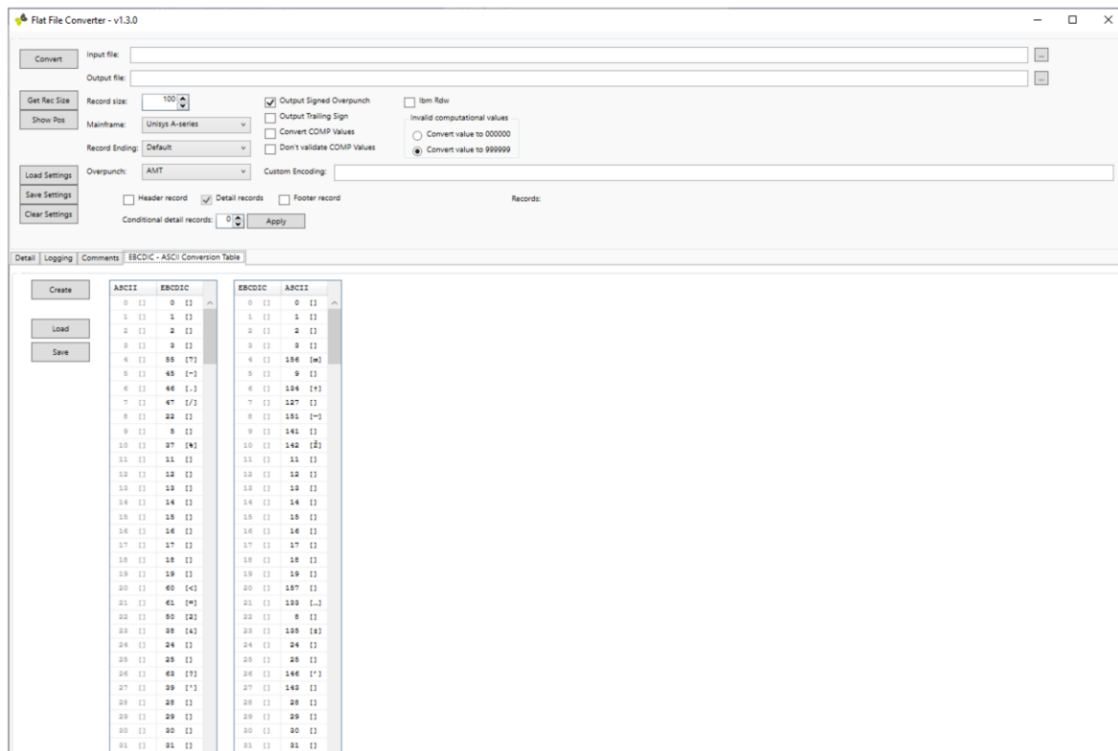
Filter:

Record Description (01 level)

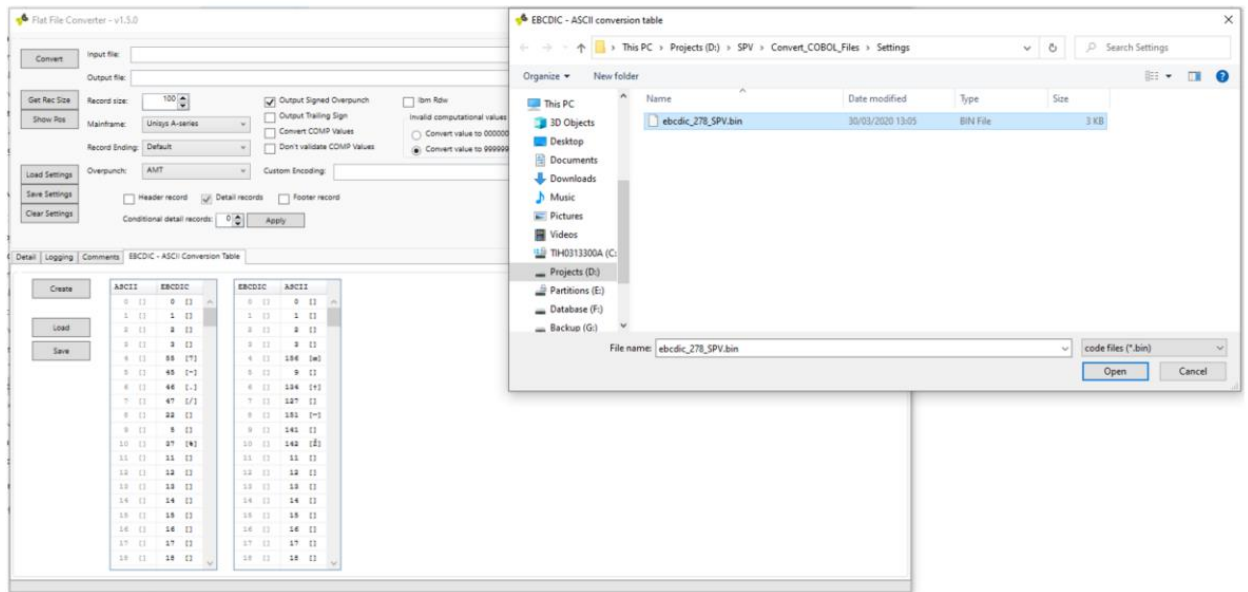
2.2 Applying an Alternative Character set

The application uses a standard EBCDIC to ASCII conversion table, but it is occasionally necessary to apply an alternative character set to the files that are being converted when they contain characters which are not found on the standard US keyboard.

The standard table can be viewed using the EBCDIC – ASCII Conversion Table tab in the lower panel.



An alternate character set can be used by selecting the Load button and navigating to the required conversion table. A Swedish character set could be used which will ensure that characters such as ä, å, ë and ö are shown and converted correctly when found in the text.

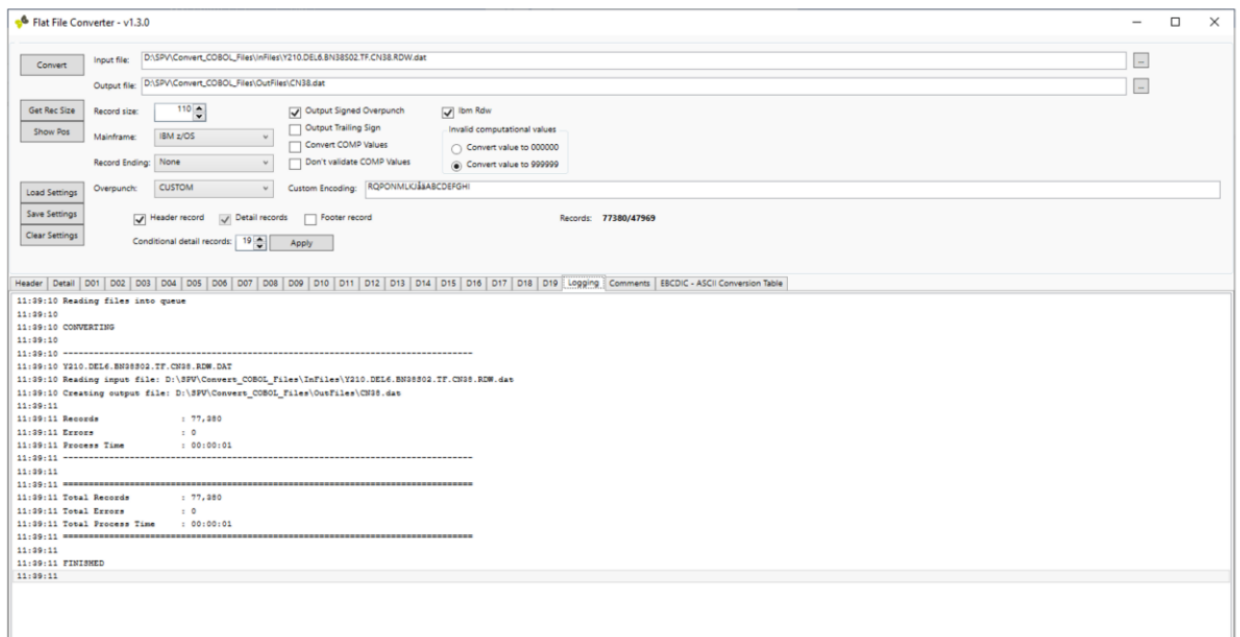


2.3 Converting the file

Once a layout has been specified that covers each different permutation of signed computational fields, then the file can be converted from its original EBCDIC format into the required Ascii format.

Ensure that the input and output file names are correctly entered in their appropriate fields (don't have the same name for both files !) and then press the "Convert" button in the button bar.

Note: It is important to note that the conversion process will not ask if you wish to overwrite a file if it already exists. Therefore, if an inappropriate file name is put in the Output File name field then it will be lost!!



The file will be processed one record at a time. Status messages and any errors from conversion will be displayed in the Log panel.

Interrogate any messages that are displayed to determine whether the filtering is being applied incorrectly, or whether a new filter is required. The row number of the record in error is displayed in the message.

2.4 Viewing the Converted Records

Following conversion of the file from EBCDIC to ASCII it is important to verify that each record (or a good cross-section of them !) has been correctly converted.

Open the converted file using a text editor such as NotePad++. Review the records and ensure that they are formatted correctly.

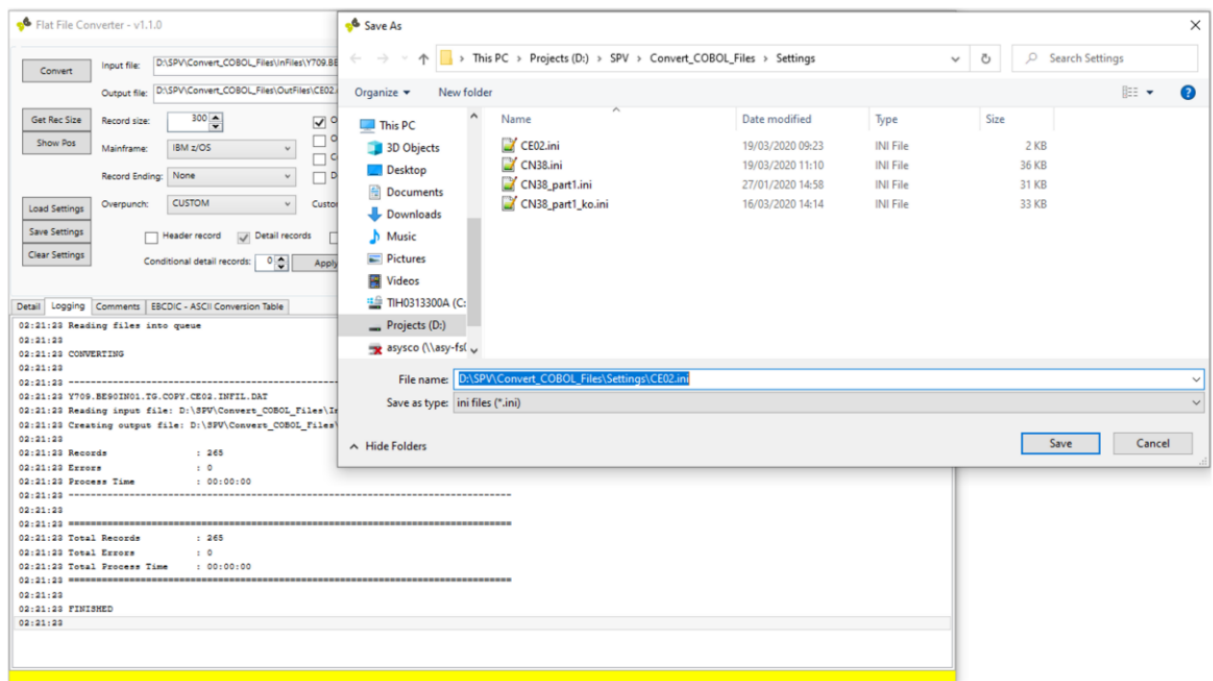
If the data cannot be displayed correctly through it's intended layout then the filtering rules or layout definitions will need to be amended, and the file re-converted.

2.5 Saving the Conversion Settings

Once you have successfully converted the file to ASCII format, the job is complete and the file is ready for use with AMT.

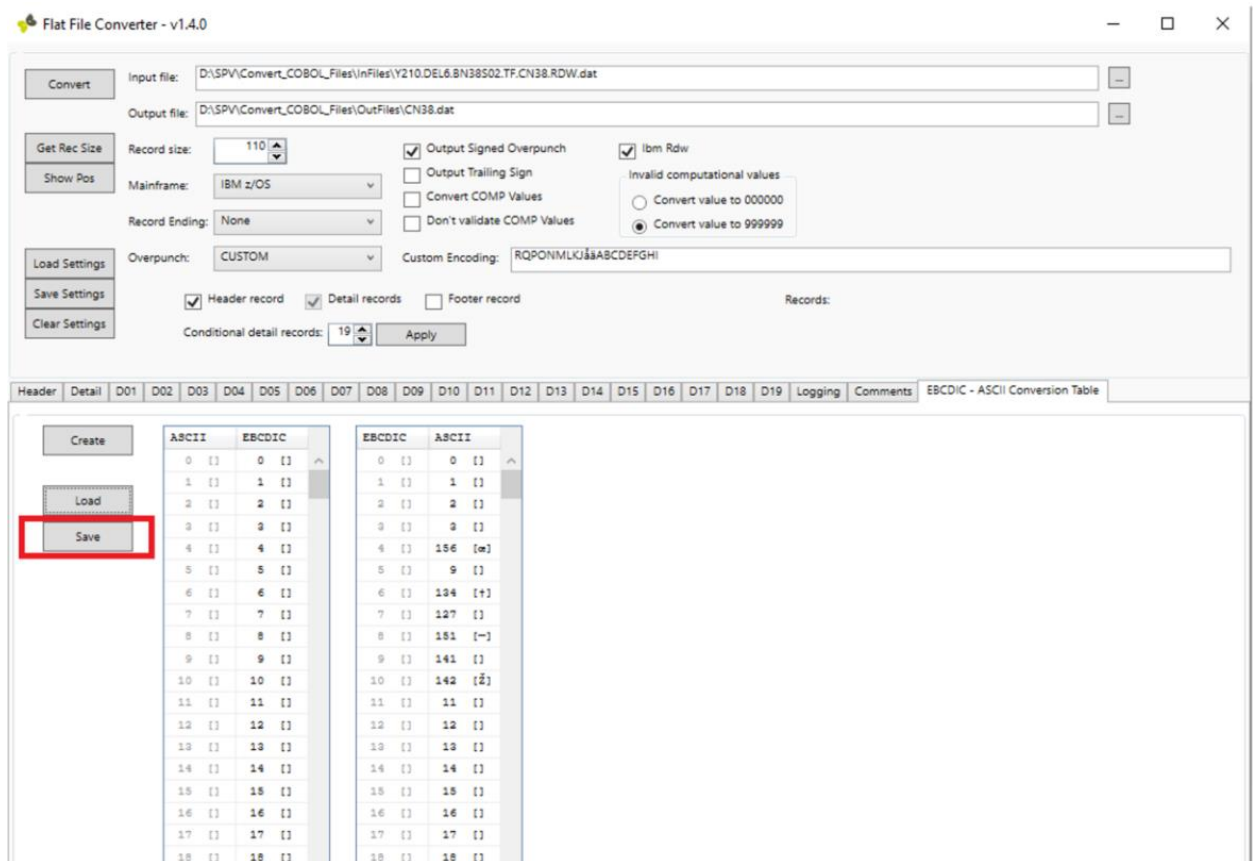
In order to reuse these conversion settings, press the “Save Settings” button on the main form.

A good tip is to use a consistent file name format – for instance, append the phrase “_Settings.ini” to the file name, and then the automatic batch creation process (see below) will have no trouble constructing a batch file.

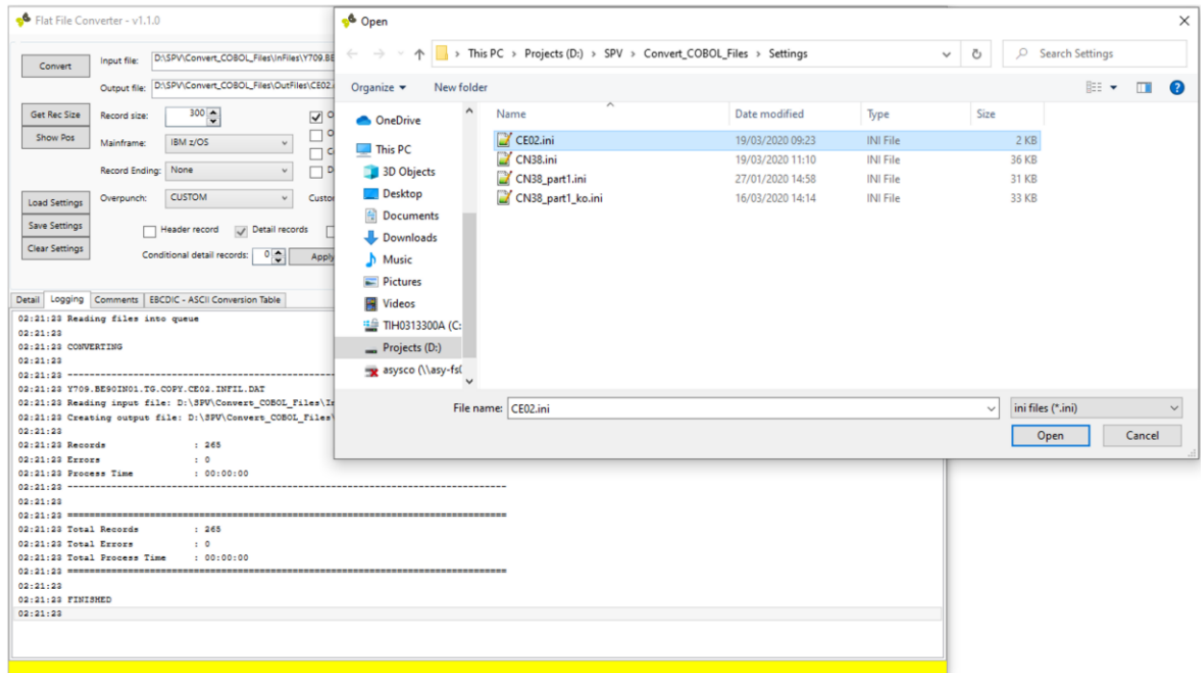


If an alternate EBCDIC to ASCII translation table has been used (see image below), this should be saved to the settings file by using the Save button on the “EBCDIC – ASCII Conversion Table” tab.

Note – the translation settings cannot be saved in the conversion settings file.



If you need to load the settings from a previous conversion, then simply start the program and load the settings file previously saved, by clicking the "Load Settings" button and selecting the appropriate file.



3 Using the AMT COBOL FileConverter to Convert Multiple Files

Launch the application and click the 'Multiple File converter' tab:

Flat File Converter - v1.0.0

Single File Converter | **Multiple File converter** | EBCDIC - ASCII Conversion Table

InputFolder: ...

OutputFolder: ...

File Control Table: ...

Line separator: Carriage return - Linefeed

Threads: 2

Mainframe: IBM z/OS

☐ Convert for Amt Java.

Convert

This conversion only works together when the switch storeCompinASCII (Java) or STORECOMPINASCII (.Net) is set to true

Logging

Logging verbose level: Normal

☐ Enable logging to file: Accepted date/time characters: [CC] (YY) (MM) (DD) (hh) (mm) (ss)

Load Settings **Save Settings**

All

A number of parameters must be specified before the conversion can take place.

The following table explains what information is required.

Parameter	Description
Input file	The location of the files to be converted. Enter the full path or use the button to navigate to the correct location

Output file	The location of the converted files. Enter the full path or use the button to navigate to the correct location
File Control Table	Point to the file control table xml file
Mainframe	Specify either Unisys or IBM
Line Separator	Choose: CRLF CR LF
Convert for AMT Java	Select if file is for an AMT JAVA application
Logging verbose level	Quiet Minimal Normal Detailed Diagnostic

See below for a sample settings file and file control table file.

Note: For files converted this way used in an AMT Java runtime, the following setting must be added to the application yaml file:

storeCompInASCII: true

A restart of the application is required after making this change.

```
runtime: true
settings: true
  customSignEncoding: ""
  cacheWorkingStorage: false
  storeCompInASCII: true
  translationFileEBCDIC: "C:\\Amt\\translationFileEBCDIC"
  useAmtCursor: true
  clientTimeout: 50000
  grpcIdleTimeout: 600
  useDate: 20250123
  fileMessageSize: 2 # MB
  addAppNameToForm: true
systemDatabase: true
```

Settingsfile.xml example:

```
<MULTIPLEFILECONVERTERSETTINGS>
  <INPUTFOLDER>C:\Temp\Binary</INPUTFOLDER>
  <OUTPUTFOLDER>C:\Temp\Convert</OUTPUTFOLDER>
  <FILECONTROLTABLE>C:\Temp\FileControlTable.xml</FILECONTROLTABLE>
  <THREADS>2</THREADS>
  <LOGGING>C:\Temp\fc.log</LOGGING>
  <LINESEPARATOR>CrLf</LINESEPARATOR>
  <MAINFRAME>IBM</MAINFRAME>
</MULTIPLEFILECONVERTERSETTINGS>
```

Within the settings file, you may specify a FileControlTable xml file that can include multiple files to be converted. See below for examples.

FileControlTable.xml example:

```
<FileControlTable>
  <File PhysicalName="FILE_A" OutputType="LineSequential"
RecordLength="390"/>
  <File PhysicalName="FILE_B" OutputType="Sequential"
RecordLength="259"/>
  <File PhysicalName="FILE_C" OutputType="Sqlite" RecordLength="150"
KeyPosition="0" KeyLength="30"/>
  <File PhysicalName="VSAM\FILE_VSAM1" OutputType="Sqlite"
RecordLength="431" KeyPosition="5" KeyLength="23"/>
  <!-- LogicalName, Description, MinRecordLength, Concurrency,
AddRequests, BrowseRequests, DeleteRequests, ReadRequests and
UpdateRequests are optional. Can be used to load VSAM info into system
database-->
  <File PhysicalName="VSAM\FILE_VSAM2" LogicalName="FILE_VSAM"
Description="My Vsam File" OutputType="Sqlite" RecordLength="431"
KeyPosition="0" KeyLength="30" MinRecordLength="19" Concurrency="0"
AddRequests="true" BrowseRequests="true" DeleteRequests="true"
ReadRequests="true" UpdateRequests="true" />
</FileControlTable>
```

4 Automating the Conversion Process

Once you have the settings files prepared, and have tested every file, you can automate the conversion of the suite of files for GO-LIVE.

5 Running in Batch

The AMT COBOL file converter can be run in batch mode either from a Windows command prompt or in a batch file. The converter should be started with the following parameter(s):

```
/INI:  
/LOG:  
/AUTO  
/TRANS:  
/NOGUI:  
e.g.  
FlatFileConvertor.exe /INI:D:\SPV\Convert_COBOL_Files\Settings\CN38.ini  
/LOG:D:\SPV\Convert_COBOL_Files\Log\Run1.log /AUTO /NOGUI  
/TRANS:D:\SPV\Convert_COBOL_Files\Settings\ebcdic_278_SPV.bin
```

The converter will open, load the settings and process the required file before closing again.

NOTE:

- The “/TRANS” option is optional
- The “/NOGUI” option is optional
- Starting without the “/AUTO” will load the ini file and translation table but will not start the data conversion; it will merely show the GUI with the parameters and file prefilled.

Starting without the “/AUTO” will load the ini file and translation table but will not start the data conversion; it will merely show the GUI with the parameters and file prefilled.

6 Running in Linux

The AMT COBOL file converter can be run in batch mode from a Linux machine using the below command:

```
dotnet FlatFileConverterConsole.dll xml:/path/to/settingsfile.xml log:/path/to/log/destination
```